

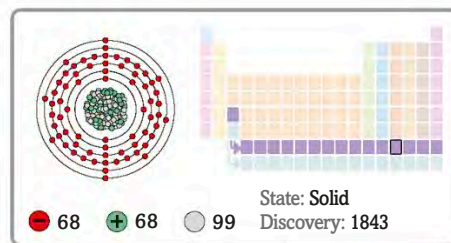
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Er

Erbium

This silvery element slowly tarnishes on contact with air.

Laboratory sample of pure erbium



This glass contains erbium, which protects a welder's eyes from heat and bright light.

The rose pink finish of this vase is from an erbium chloride glaze.



Welding goggles

pink pottery



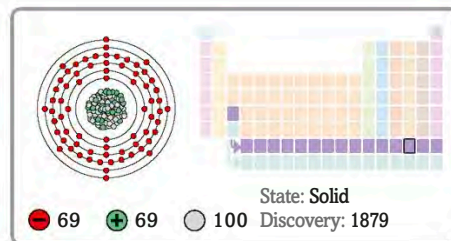
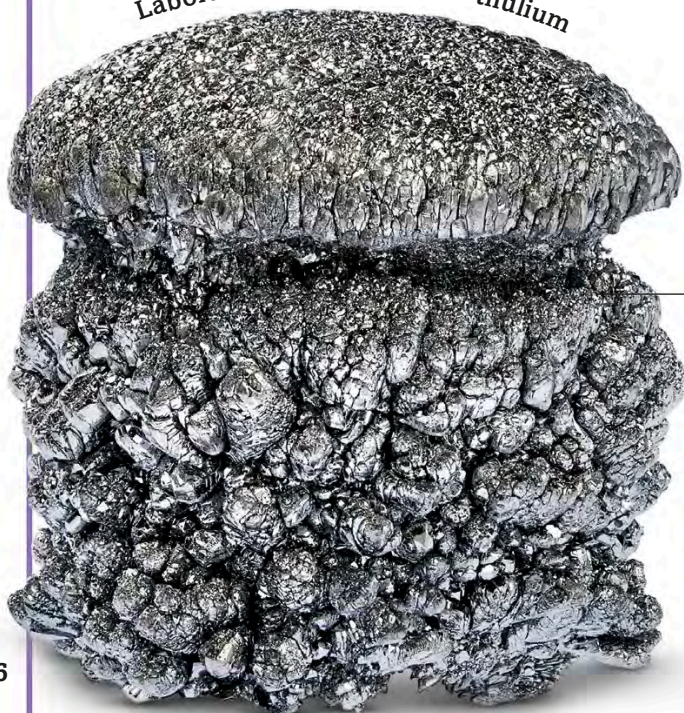
Like terbium and ytterbium, erbium is also named after the Swedish village of Ytterby, near which it was discovered. This element does not occur in its **pure form** in nature, but it can be obtained from the mineral monazite. Many erbium compounds are pink in colour and are used to colour **pottery** and glass.

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Tm

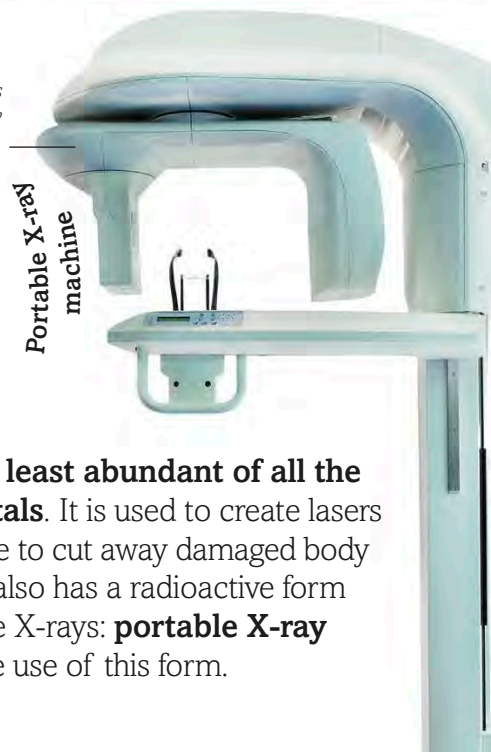
Thulium

Laboratory sample of pure thulium



This machine emits X-rays using a very small amount of thulium.

This soft metal glows blue under ultraviolet (UV) light.



Portable X-ray machine

Thulium is the least abundant of all the lanthanide metals. It is used to create lasers that surgeons use to cut away damaged body tissue. Thulium also has a radioactive form that can produce X-rays: **portable X-ray machines** make use of this form.